NZRA Newsletter - October 2004

The Rogaining Calendar has been relatively quiet over the last few months but there are a number of excellent events coming up shortly. Details may be found via the Event Calendar at www.rogaine.org.nz .

HOT ROCs 8hr Rogaine with a 4hr option – Saturday 30th October. Entries close Saturday 23rd October. Download an entry form from the Rotorua Orienteering website **www.geocities.com/rotorua-oc/**

Lance Eccles reports:-

Planning is well advanced. The Whaka Forest is truly a stunning area. Beautiful native bush (even the deer are present so close to town). Plantation pine trees and more tracks than you've had hot dinners. Some of the route choices will allow off track navigation, although most are on tracks from wide, sealed Forestry roads to narrow, fern overgrown single tracks. There is a "cluster" of controls buried deep in the Redwoods plus several very high pointers on top of some distant landmarks. You'll pass geothermal activity and some of New Zealand's most beautiful lakes. Take a look at the photo on the NZRA website to get a feel of the territory you're going to be in.

There are 4 and 8-hour options, or you may wish to take a shorter route.

Rimutaka Rogaine – Saturday 13th November, 12hr & 6hr options, Rimutaka Forest Park. Organiser is Mike Sheridan for the Hutt Valley Orienteering Club. Download an entry form from the NZRA website www.rogaine.org.nz . Entries close 6th November.

The Prophets Rock E.P.I.C. – Saturday 20th/21st November. A Bruce McLeod 24hr or 12hr special near Clyde, Central Otago. Entries close Friday 5th November. See the EPIC website http://www.epicnavigation.co.nz/ for further information.

Bruce has been out and about and tells us:-

The 2004 E.P.I.C. is shaping up to be another rocky experience... quite literally!! After several expeditions into the hills we have placed heaps of checkpoints, found loads of interesting features, climbed lots of pinnacles, peered over cliffs, waded rivers, and plodded through snow! This year we are offering a 12hr and a 24hr course (with a mountain-bike section in the 24hr)... so find a partner, or two, or three and come along to explore another stunning spot in sunny Central Otago!!

The race entry forms and further information are available on-line at http://www.epicnavigation.co.nz/. Please print the entry form, add your details and post to EPIC Navigation...but be quick, due to venue capacity numbers will be limited.

New Zealand Championships 2005 - "The Nenthorn Nemesis". Classic 24hr event on Saturday/ Sunday 26th/27th February in the historic Middlemarch area, Central Otago. (There may be a shorter option yet to be decided).

Bob Cunninghame has been busy sorting out a course and getting all the necessary landowner permissions. More information and entry forms will be available early December on the NZRA website www.rogaine.org.nz .

Despite the title of NZ Championships this event is for anyone who wishes to enter. It is not limited to elite athletes and there will be many "ordinary mortals" like you enjoying the chance to explore some extremely interesting country.

Wilderness Article: "Rogaining - the Essence of the Map"

Grant Hunter burst into print to promote rogaining with an article "**Rogaining - the Essence of the Map**" in the Wilderness Magazine. The item is reproduced, with permission, on the NZRA website. Take a look.

Grant has organised a number of Rogaines over the years beginning with the Heights of Winter. As Grant says in the article he gets more pleasure from organising than from competing. He tells you why in the article.

We need more people like Grant. If **you** would like to help organise a Rogaine, or have a good idea on a suitable locality, talk with Pete Squires, Dave Laurie, or one of the other people in the Contacts list on the NZRA website. Grant, Dave or Pete would give you a good idea of what is involved.

Walking Pole

Val Rogers would like to make contact with the person who won the right-hand walking pole at the Heights of Winter this year. Val won the left-hand one and would like to make an offer for the other so she has a matched pair. If you are the person who won the right then please phone Val on (03)348 6606.

Nigel Aylott

We were saddened to hear of the recent tragic death of Nigel Aylott, who was hit by a falling rock during the Subaru Primal Quest Adventure Race in Washington State, USA. Nigel was a very dominant person in Australian and World regaining circles, both competitively and administratively. He has been World Champion and Australian champion, and has competed in NZ.

Nigel's ability was legendary, and he was always regarded as one of the main elite contenders in any competition he entered. When people ask me about competitive Rogaining, I often quote Nigel's 100 km training runs as an example of the dedication and ability that top competitors have. It was always a thrill to know that Nigel was competing in an event, and it was always great to talk to him afterwards to find out his strategy and how he went. I think the finest example of precision timing I ever saw in a Rogaine was Nigel's team trotting in to the finish with five seconds to spare in the Gundy 24hr Australian Champs Rogaine.

I also have everlasting memories of the 1998 Kamloops World Champs, where the temperature reached 41 degrees. With only two hours to go, we arrived at a small stream junction in the middle of nowhere at the same time as Nigel and his team mate came trotting up from the other direction. I asked him how long he had been running and he said "22 hours".

Nigel's death is a huge loss for the Rogaining community at large, and for each of us who knew him individually. We will be all too aware of his absence at major Rogaines for a long time to come. On behalf of the NZRA I have expressed our condolences to the Australian Rogaining Association.

Pete Squires.